

These animations are devoid of any explanatory notes, implying that they are targeted at other educators to be used as demonstrations in conjunction with relevant reading material. Nevertheless, students looking for additional material to better understand a concept will find the animations useful. Most animations are small in size, ranging from a few KB to a few hundred KB, with only one exceeding 1 MB in size. A brief description of the animation, its size, and the version of the Flash plug-in required to view the animation accompany each file. Most of the animations allow the user to change values and observe the changes, while a few are just for viewing. In any case, they are better at aiding comprehension than mere static images that exist on Web pages or in textbooks.

In conclusion, the lack of detailed explanatory notes takes away some of the value of this otherwise excellent site.

1.7.3 Maths, Physics and Engineering Applets

(www.falstad.com/mathphysics.html)

This site is the creation of Paul Falstad, who offers little information about himself. This self-effacement, though, only magnifies the utility of his creation. The site offers about 40 Java applets covering different topics in physics, like Oscillations and Waves, Acoustics, Signal Processing, Electricity and Magnetism, Statics, Electrodynamics, Quantum Mechanics, Linear Algebra, Vector Calculus, and Thermodynamics. Besides applets on these topics, the site also has links to other sites offering similar content.

A one-line description accompanies the link to the applet. Of the sites discussed here, this one probably offers the most well-crafted applets. The applets offer greater changeable parameters and overall appear sharper. It is easy to see that a physics student would be spending a lot of time on each applet trying out its different possibilities. Each applet is accompanied by brief instructions, and if required, even detailed instructions can be accessed